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01 / ECONOMY

India's **Number One** State Economy

When the DMK government assumed office in May 2021, Tamil Nadu faced the full economic disruption of COVID-19. Industries were shuttered, businesses pushed to the edge, revenue strained. The administration chose recovery through investment rather than retrenchment — and the data five years later tells the story of a wager that paid off spectacularly.

0.07% →

₹17.89L →

11.19%

Economic growth rate: from near-zero in 2020–21 to highest in India by 2024–25

₹31.19L Cr

GSDP growth over 5 years — 16% increase, India's #1 rank

₹2,09,628 → ₹3,61,619

Per capita income — now 1.76× the national average

2.20% → 1.43%

Poverty rate — declined 11.2 percentage points below the national average

3rd → 1st

Electricity infrastructure exports — rose to India's top position

74 → 78.8

SDG (Sustainable Development Goals) score — 3rd in India

The export readiness index improved from 64.93 to 80.89 points, placing Tamil Nadu first nationally in manufacturing exports. The state was internationally described as India's "Super Star State" by foreign analysts. The target set by Deputy CM Udhayanidhi Stalin — a \$1 trillion economy by 2030 — is not rhetoric; it is arithmetic built on a verified five-year trajectory.

₹12 Lakh Cr

Total investment attracted through Global Investors Meet and policy reforms

35 Lakh

Jobs created from new investments — directly verified

38%

Of India's footwear & leather production comes from Tamil Nadu alone

₹6,045 Cr

Allocated for North Chennai development — transforming TN's industrial heartland

Tamil Nadu became India's #1 state in automobile and EV manufacturing. After languishing at the bottom of startup rankings in 2018, the state reached first position by 2022. The Tidel Neo parks — 14 new mini tech parks across districts — brought IT industry employment out of Chennai into every corner of the state.

"Tamil Nadu is today the front-runner in India's economic progress — leading in investment attraction, in manufacturing, and in creating opportunity for all its people."

— M. Ramesh, Senior Journalist, *Thamizharasu*

02 / WELFARE

The Dravidian Model — Welfare as a Right

The phrase "Dravidian Model" became shorthand for a governing philosophy: welfare is not charity, it is a right. Tamil Nadu under the

DMK government expanded welfare delivery to a scale not seen in any comparable Indian state — and did so while simultaneously growing the economy at record speed, disproving the false choice between welfare and growth.

1.31 Crore

Families receiving ₹1,000/month under Kalaingar Magalir Urimai — ₹29,000 cumulative by Jan 2026

71.81 Lakh

Women using free bus travel daily; each saving ₹800–₹1,200/month

₹60,000

Total savings per family accumulated through free bus travel scheme

27.55 Lakh

Elderly and differently-abled receiving ration goods at their doorstep (Thaayumanavar)

The Pongal prize of ₹3,000 cash was distributed to 2.23 crore families. The elderly pension (Muthuvor Oyvuthiyam) reached 33.60 lakh existing beneficiaries, with 1.80 lakh additional persons added — and the monthly amount raised from ₹1,000 to ₹1,200. The government's framing was clear: no Tamil family should enter a festival empty-handed.

The Universal PDS covered over two crore families. Free breakfast for government school students (Classes 1–5) reached 20.59 lakh children daily — attacking hunger and improving school attendance simultaneously. This scheme won the United Nations' highest award for public service.

"We were here for the people. We existed for the people. We will continue to live for the people."

— M.K. Stalin, Chief Minister, Tamil Nadu

03 / EDUCATION

Education as Social Revolution

Tamil Nadu's higher education gross enrollment ratio surpassed 50% — against a national average of just 28%. This alone places the state in a different category from any other large Indian state on educational access. But the government's ambition went beyond enrollment numbers to the quality and direction of what students learned.

48.65 Lakh

Students trained for IAS, IPS, and global competitive exams through Naan Mudhalvan

12.35 Lakh

Students receiving ₹1,000/month through Pudhumai Penn & Thamizh Pudhalvan higher education schemes

385

20 Lakh

Students sent to Oxford, Cambridge, MIT, and other world-class universities under Annai Ambedkar Scheme; ₹162 Cr disbursed

Free laptops distributed; another 10 lakh to be distributed — India's largest student laptop programme

- 98.3% of government higher secondary schools now have science labs — versus only 50% nationally. Tamil Nadu's school science infrastructure surpassed the national benchmark comprehensively.
- The Illam (Education at Doorstep) programme addressed Thedi COVID learning loss by sending trained volunteers to Kalvi students' homes — improving learning outcomes measurably in rural districts.
- 38 model schools, 37 new government arts and science colleges, and new facilities built across districts — bringing quality higher education within reach of every taluk.
- The Kalaigamar Centenary Library in Chennai opened — a world-class research facility in honour of the late Chief Minister M. Karunanidhi, offering public access to digital and physical collections.
- New world-class libraries opened in Madurai, Coimbatore (Periyar), Tiruchi (Kamarasar), and Salem (Bharathidasan) — placing library infrastructure in every major city.
- Free bus travel was extended to all girl students up to degree level — directly reducing female dropout rates by removing the transport barrier.

Tamil Women — Leading, Working, Winning

Tamil Nadu has the highest proportion of women in factory employment in India — approximately 43% of industrial workers in the state are women, a figure that is the national record. The government treated this not as a statistic to celebrate but as a responsibility to protect and advance.

1.31 Cr

Women heads of household receiving ₹1,000/month — ₹29,000 cumulative by Jan 2026

71.81 Lakh

Daily free bus commuters — saving each family thousands of rupees per year

₹1.34L Cr

Total credit to women's SHGs over 5 years; ₹2,756 Cr in loan waivers

19

Thozhi hostels built for working women — high-quality safe accommodation across industrial districts

- 1% stamp duty waiver on property registration for women buyers — the first such measure in Tamil Nadu's history, directly enabling women to own assets.
- Free cervical cancer vaccination for girls under 14 — India's first state to implement this at scale, protecting a generation of girls from a preventable cancer.
- 50% reservation in local body elections was maintained and strengthened, with elected women representatives receiving dedicated capacity-building support.
- The 33% reservation for women in state government appointments was implemented — the first large state in India to institutionalise gender parity at the administrative leadership level.
- Tamil Nadu confirmed as India's safest state for women — street crime against women measured at 24 times below the national average (AVTAR survey).

to Your Door

"Healthcare for All — Wellness for All" was not a campaign slogan but a policy architecture. The government restructured Tamil Nadu's health delivery around the principle that geography should not determine whether you live or die — and that the nearest hospital should not require a three-hour journey.

2.56 Crore

People treated through Makkalai Thedi Maruthuvam (Medicine at Doorstep) — won UN Global Award

5 Lakh+

Lives saved within 48 hours through road accident emergency response (Namakkaagum 48)

₹483 Crore

Compensation paid to accident victims through the Namakkaagum 48 scheme

₹6,769 Crore

Insurance coverage disbursed under CM's Comprehensive Health Insurance Scheme (2,053 procedures; 1.45 Cr families)

- The Kalaingar Centenary Super Speciality Hospital opened in Kilpauk — 1,000 beds, 15 operation theatres, world-class equipment, free for patients. The largest government super-speciality hospital built in Tamil Nadu's history.
- 1,256 upgraded health centres and 17 specialty medical services were added across the district network — bringing specialist care to towns that previously had none.

- The maternal per infant — among the lowest mortality rate lakh mortality in India, approaching fell from 73 births; rate fell from European standards. to 40 the 10.4 to 6.9
- Tamil first state in India to to girls under 14 — protecting Nadu give free HPV them from a cancer that kills became (cervical cancer) thousands of Indian women the vaccinations annually.
- Free for 65+ elderly and disabled — no patient in a medicines government scheme should have to travel to collect home their monthly prescription. delivery

"Tamil Nadu's healthcare infrastructure is now rising to world standards. The goal — healthcare for all — is being achieved."

Tamil Farmers & Fishers

Agriculture and fishing are not peripheral sectors in Tamil Nadu — they are the livelihood of tens of millions of families. The government's approach was to treat minimum support prices, credit access, and technology as rights, not gifts.

66.24 Lakh

Farmers given crop loans totalling ₹53,340 Crore — the largest agricultural credit in Tamil Nadu's history

2 Lakh

New free electricity connections to farmers; ₹206 Cr for 2 lakh natural farming beneficiaries

₹2,500/quintal

Paddy MSP raised — protecting rice farmers from market volatility

₹38/litre

Milk procurement price raised from ₹35 — benefiting dairy farmers across the state

Tamil Nadu became India's #1 producer of oilseeds, groundnut, and sugarcane. In maize production it ranked second nationally. The state's farm productivity was maintained through sustained investment in irrigation — 121 check dams and 101 dam reservoirs were constructed or restored.

For the fishing community, the government's commitment was equally concrete. The seasonal fishing ban compensation was raised from ₹5,000 to ₹8,000 per family. The Tamil Nadu Fishermen Welfare Board provided ₹12.43 Crore in relief to 9,547 persons. Across the state, 72 new fish landing centres were built at a cost of ₹1,428 Crore

— modernising the infrastructure that fishermen depend on daily. The daily support allowance for families of fishermen who die at sea was raised from ₹250 to ₹350.

"Cyclones and storms bring no obstacle — the hard-working fishers of Tamil Nadu face nothing that cannot be overcome."

— Anitha R. Radhakrishnan, Fisheries Minister

07 / HERITAGE

Rewriting History With Science

One of the most intellectually ambitious initiatives of this government was its investment in Tamil archaeology — funded, systematic, and internationally recognised. The state made the argument, with evidence, that Tamil civilisation is older than previously acknowledged, and it made that argument with science rather than sentiment.

- At Keeladi, excavations between 2020 and 2025 confirmed iron technology in Tamil society over 5,000 years ago — rewriting assumptions about ancient South Indian metallurgy. The Keeladi and Porunai museums were established to present these findings to the world.
- Tamil Nadu became the only Indian state with its own dedicated State Archaeology Department (TNSDA) — independent of the ASI, with its own budget, research mandate, and authority. A landmark assertion of cultural sovereignty.
- Scientific dating (AMS, OSL) confirmed dates of 2,600 years BP for Keeladi finds — pushing Tamil urban civilisation centuries earlier than acknowledged. Tamil Nadu led nationally in the application of modern science to archaeology.
- The Dravidam Heritage Museum in Chennai traced the social reform movement from the Justice Party through Periyar and Ambedkar to the DMK — connecting the historical reform tradition to living governance values.
- The Valluvarkottam and Victoria Public Hall in Chennai were restored — returning two iconic cultural landmarks to public use.
- Minority community welfare : ₹39 Crore for Haj facilities; ₹10 Crore for restoration of historic temples.

The government's devotion to Tamil identity extended to its religious and cultural infrastructure. 4,000 Hindu temples received renovation and maintenance funding, with ₹8,000 Crore worth of temple property restored. The Semmozhip Punga (Classical Tamil Language Park) was built in Coimbatore's Gandhinagar at a cost of ₹208 Crore — a world-class public space celebrating the classical Tamil language. 23 memorial halls and 70 statues of Tamil leaders and reformers were erected across the state, making public space itself a classroom in the Dravidian tradition.

A grand new Kalaigiar Centenary Arena was built in Madurai — a massive cultural venue as a symbol of Tamil identity in the ancient city. The Valluvarkottam and Victoria Public Hall in Chennai were restored. On language, the government stood firm against the three-language (Hindi imposition) policy — protecting Tamil's status as the primary medium of education and state administration. New national-level literary awards including the Ilakkiya Mamani, Kalaigiar Ezhuthugol, and Semmozhip prizes were instituted, and award-winning writers were given housing.

08 / INFRASTRUCTURE

Building the State People Deserve

Infrastructure was treated not as prestige spending but as welfare

delivery. A road to a village is a school for a child who can now attend. A water connection is a woman freed from daily labour. Every infrastructure number below is also a human story.

24,774 km

Roads built and improved, including 180 elevated bridges — the NTR bridge and Veera Mangai Velunachiyar bridge among the landmarks

2 Lakh

Kalaighar Kanavu Illam (quality houses) built; ₹3,500 Cr committed for 1 lakh more

75 Lakh

Drinking water connections through 87 group water supply schemes — serving 3 Crore people

121 + 101

Check dams and reservoir dams built for water conservation and irrigation

The government's housing scheme for the poor — named after the late Chief Minister Kalaighar — prioritised dignity: proper flooring, ventilation, secure roofing. These were permanent homes, not temporary shelters. In North Chennai, ₹6,045 Crore was allocated for an integrated development plan transforming one of India's most industrially important but historically underinvested urban zones.

Tamil Nadu maintained its top position in India under the Jal Jeevan Mission (tap water to every household). 75 lakh new connections meant that millions of families — predominantly women — were freed from the daily burden of water collection. The state's 87 group water supply schemes reached 3 crore people across both urban and rural areas.

- 20,484 km of rural roads upgraded at a cost of ₹8,911 Crore — with a further ₹1,088 Crore committed for 2,200 km more. Every village in Tamil Nadu now has paved road access.
- New state-of-the-art Kalaighar Centenary Bus Terminus built in Chennai (Kilambakkam) and the Tiruchi Panjappur terminus — replacing aging infrastructure with modern, accessible facilities for millions of daily commuters.
- 14 Tidel Neo parks — new mini IT parks across 14 districts — bringing technology sector employment out of Chennai to every region.
- Tamil Nadu is now India's #1 state in automobile and EV manufacturing — with VinFast, Hyundai, and multiple EV supply chain companies establishing facilities.
- The Chennai Metro Phase 2 was accelerated, with multiple new corridors under construction — expanding the city's mass transit capacity for the next generation.
- 22.71 lakh poor families received free house site pattas (land title deeds) — giving them legal ownership of land for the first time, a direct strike against landlessness.

The Oldest Promise, Kept at Scale

The Dravidian movement was born in Tamil Nadu as a social justice movement. The 2021–2026 government made specific, measurable commitments to communities that had historically been excluded — and it kept them, visibly and at scale.

2.23 Crore

Families received ₹3,000 Pongal cash gift — the largest annual festival welfare transfer in TN history

33.60 Lakh

Elderly on pension; 1.80 lakh additional added; amount raised ₹1,000 → ₹1,200/month

13,000+

Differently-abled persons now have dedicated representation posts in local bodies

8,685

Public events attended personally by the CM; 15,117 files signed; 173 district field visits

→ Tamil Nadu's 69% internal reservation policy was legally defended and upheld — a constitutional victory protecting the rights of BC, MBC, SC, and ST communities.

- Manual scavenging was declared fully eliminated in Tamil Nadu — with rehabilitation, housing, and livelihood support provided to former manual scavengers and their families.
- Tamil Nadu confirmed as India's #1 state in women's safety — with crime against women at 24× below the national average, backed by CCTV infrastructure, all-women police units, and fast-track courts.
- The TAPS/APS guaranteed pension scheme — a 23-year demand by government employees — was implemented, providing retirement security to the state's workforce.
- Anganwadi and Sathunaval worker pensions raised from ₹2,000 to ₹3,400 ; rural anganwadi workers from ₹2,000 to ₹3,200 — with service completion benefits doubled to ₹2 lakh. Cook and cleaner pensions similarly raised from ₹2,000 to ₹3,000 , with ₹1 lakh gratuity.
- ₹5,700 Crore allocated for welfare of differently-abled persons — Tamil Nadu received the Central Government's national award for best services to the differently-abled community.

- Tholkudi (Pazhangudiyinar) and Ayodhyasar tribal settlement schemes — ₹1,000 Crore each — improving housing and infrastructure in scheduled tribe communities across the state.
- Government employees' Dearness Allowance (DA) raised from 17% to 58% — the largest DA revision in Tamil Nadu's history, protecting government workers from inflation.

"Leave no one behind — this is the social justice doctrine of the Dravidian Model government."

10 / GOVERNANCE & SPORTS

Accountable, Present, Relentlessly Active

The numbers of personal CM engagement — 8,685 public events, 15,117 files personally signed, 173 district field visits — are not administrative statistics. They represent a Chief Minister who governed in person, in public, at scale. Tamil Nadu's administration

under M.K. Stalin was characterised by visibility and accountability.

- Tamil Nadu ranked #1 in India in women's safety, women's employment, and startup ecosystem — three separate national rankings, all earned during this five-year term.
- Law and order: communal violence was contained across all districts — the state maintained peace through active police presence and legal deterrence.
- The Ungaludan Stalin (Stalin With You) programme placed the CM in direct accessibility — public grievances heard, filed, and tracked to resolution through a formal state system.
- Tamil Nadu's COVID-19 response was cited nationally as a model — low mortality relative to population, early vaccination, and health infrastructure that absorbed the crisis.
- In sports: 141 mini stadiums, sports equipment to 12,620 villages, and 200 athletes given government jobs — making sports a career path, not a hobby.
- The Sports University — Tamil Nadu's first — was established, offering degrees in sports science, coaching, management, and physiotherapy.

The government also reformed and expanded the civil services — recruiting 70,022 new government employees across departments in

the most significant public sector hiring in a generation. All appointments followed representation quotas strictly.

"What is the Dravidian Model? It is the pursuit of a society without hunger, without disease, without ignorance, and without discrimination — and on each of these dimensions, Tamil Nadu is making real, measurable progress."

— M.K. Stalin, Chief Minister, Tamil Nadu, 2026

CLOSING NOTE

Five Years. A Record That Endures.

Elections are moments. Governance is the accumulation of days. Whatever the verdict of any single election, the record assembled here — drawn from 966 pages of official documentation across two government publications — reflects something more durable: an attempt, sustained over five years, to govern Tamil Nadu with the scale and sincerity its people deserve.

Tamil Nadu's GSDP grew from ₹17.89 lakh crore to ₹31.19 lakh crore. Over 1.31 crore women received cash in hand every month. Keeladi's excavations proved 5,000-year-old iron technology. 48.65 lakh

students prepared for IAS and global exams. 385 students went to Oxford and MIT. 2.56 crore people received medicine at their doorstep. Maternal mortality halved (73→40). 66 lakh farmers received ₹53,340 Crore in crop loans. 72 new fishing harbours were built. 24,774 km of highways and 20,484 km of rural roads were laid. 75 lakh water connections were installed. 22.71 lakh poor families got free land pattas. 4,000 temples were renovated. The Semmozhip Punga opened in Coimbatore. The Kalaignar Centenary Library opened in Chennai. Manual scavenging was eliminated. The 23-year pension demand was met. The DA was raised from 17% to 58%. ₹5,700 Crore was spent on the differently-abled. ₹12 lakh crore in investment was attracted, creating 35 lakh jobs.

This is not a political argument. It is a record. The people of Tamil Nadu will interpret it as they see fit. But the record is there — documented, published, verifiable — and it is a tribute worth making.

"Tamil Nadu will rise again. Tamil Nadu will win. Again and again and again — we will win."

— M.K. Stalin, Chief Minister

Sources:

- (1) Makkhal Paniyil Magathana 5 Aandugal 2021–26 (மக்கள் பணியில் மகத்தான 5 ஆண்டுகள்) — Official Tamil Nadu Government Publication, 914 pages.
- (2) Ellolarukkum Ellam Dravida Maadam Aatchi — DMK IT Wing, 52 pages (CM Stalin's Assembly Speech summary, January 24, 2026).

Compiled and translated as a tribute by a reader who values what was built.

TAMIL NADU · 2021–2026